

★ STAAR Math Lesson Plans ★

5 Fun & Engaging TEKS-Aligned Lessons

Grades 3–5 | Teach4Texas

⚠️ PREVIEW — Sample pages only

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⚠️ PREVIEW — Full Lesson 1 Sample

Lesson 1: Math Mystery Detective 🔍

Grade: 3rd **TEKS:** 3.4K, 3.5B **Duration:** 60 minutes **Materials:** Mystery case folders (printed), dry erase boards, markers, "Evidence Logs" (printed), manipulatives

Learning Objective

I can solve multiplication and division word problems by identifying clues in the text and choosing the correct operation.

STAAR Connection

Practices **multi-step problem solving** and **constructed response** — both key STAAR 2.0 formats.

Warm-Up (10 minutes): "Detective Training"

Display these "Quick Cases" one at a time:

1. "There are 4 teams. Each team has 6 players. How many players in all?" ($4 \times 6 = 24$)
2. "24 stickers shared equally among 3 friends. How many each?" ($24 \div 3 = 8$)
3. "A baker made 5 trays of cookies. Each tray has 7 cookies. He gave away 10 cookies. How many are left?" ($5 \times 7 = 35$; $35 - 10 = 25$)

Key: For #3, ask "What makes this problem HARDER than #1 and #2?" (two steps!)

Main Activity (25 minutes): "The Case of the Missing Math"

Divide class into teams of 3–4. Each team receives a "Mystery Case Folder" with 4 cases.

Case #1: The Pet Store Puzzle

Mr. Garcia's pet store received 8 boxes of dog treats. Each box has 9 bags inside. He put the bags on 6 shelves equally. How many bags are on each shelf?

Solution: $8 \times 9 = 72$ bags total; $72 \div 6 = 12$ bags per shelf

Case #2: The Lunch Room Mystery

The cafeteria ordered 56 cartons of milk for 7 classes. Each class got the same number. Then 3 cartons from Mrs. Lee's class were returned. How many good cartons does Mrs. Lee's class have?

Solution: $56 \div 7 = 8$ cartons per class; $8 - 3 = 5$ good cartons

Case #3: The Field Trip Fiasco

48 students are going on a field trip. Each van holds 8 students. The school already has 2 vans. How many MORE vans does the school need to rent?

Solution: $48 \div 8 = 6$ vans needed; $6 - 2 = 4$ more vans to rent

Case #4: The Birthday Party Problem (Challenge)

Mia is buying party favors for 9 friends: 3 stickers, 2 erasers, 1 pencil each. Stickers come in packs of 9. Erasers come in packs of 6. How many packs of each?

Stickers: $9 \times 3 = 27$; $27 \div 9 = 3$ packs. Erasers: $9 \times 2 = 18$; $18 \div 6 = 3$ packs.

Practice (15 minutes): Solo Detective Work

Students independently solve 2 STAAR-format problems.

Exit Ticket (10 minutes)

3-question formative assessment in STAAR 2.0 format.

Lessons 2–5 + all printables included in the full version...

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